The Lean Canvas

Designed for: Personalize Credit Card Recommendation System

Designed by: PCCRS Team

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Version: 1.0

Problem

1) Users don't know which card actually fits their spending pattern; generic rankings are misleading and biased by sponsorships.
2) Rewards are hard to value — cash-back vs points vs transfer partners.
3) Benefits & fees are complex (credits, annual fee, category caps, rotating categories), users can't compute break-even on their own.

Solution

1) Categorize spend by MCC → category.
2) Compute expected annual value per card (rewards − annual fees + credits).
3) Recommend the best 1–3 cards with reasoning + sensitivity analysis (e.g., point-value slider).

Unique Value Prop.

"Turn your actual spending into an explainable, optimized credit-card strategy — not a generic ranking."

Unfair Advantage

- Explainable optimization with break-even + sensitivity analysis;
- Clear "system guarantees" + repeatable, deterministic test cases.

Customer Segments

- Regular users: people with stable monthly spend who want to maximize rewards without doing manual math.
- Power users: travel hackers who care about transfer partner valuations & multi-card stacking.

Existing Alternatives

- NerdWallet / The Points Guy / bank marketing pages (generic lists, sponsor bias);
- Spreadsheet DIY / Reddit "best card" threads (high effort, low personalization, outdated);
- Issuer pre-qualification tools (issuer-centric, not user value-maximizing).

Key Metrics

- Recommendation acceptance rate (user "saves" a plan)
- Estimated net value improvement ($/year) vs baseline
- User retention (repeat runs/month).

High-Level Concept

Data-Driven Credit Card Value Engine

Channels

- Course demo + class feedback
- GitLab repo + short demo video
- Simple web landing: "Upload your spend CSV and get a plan."

Early Adopters

Students / young professionals with predictable spend + interest in travel points

Cost Structure

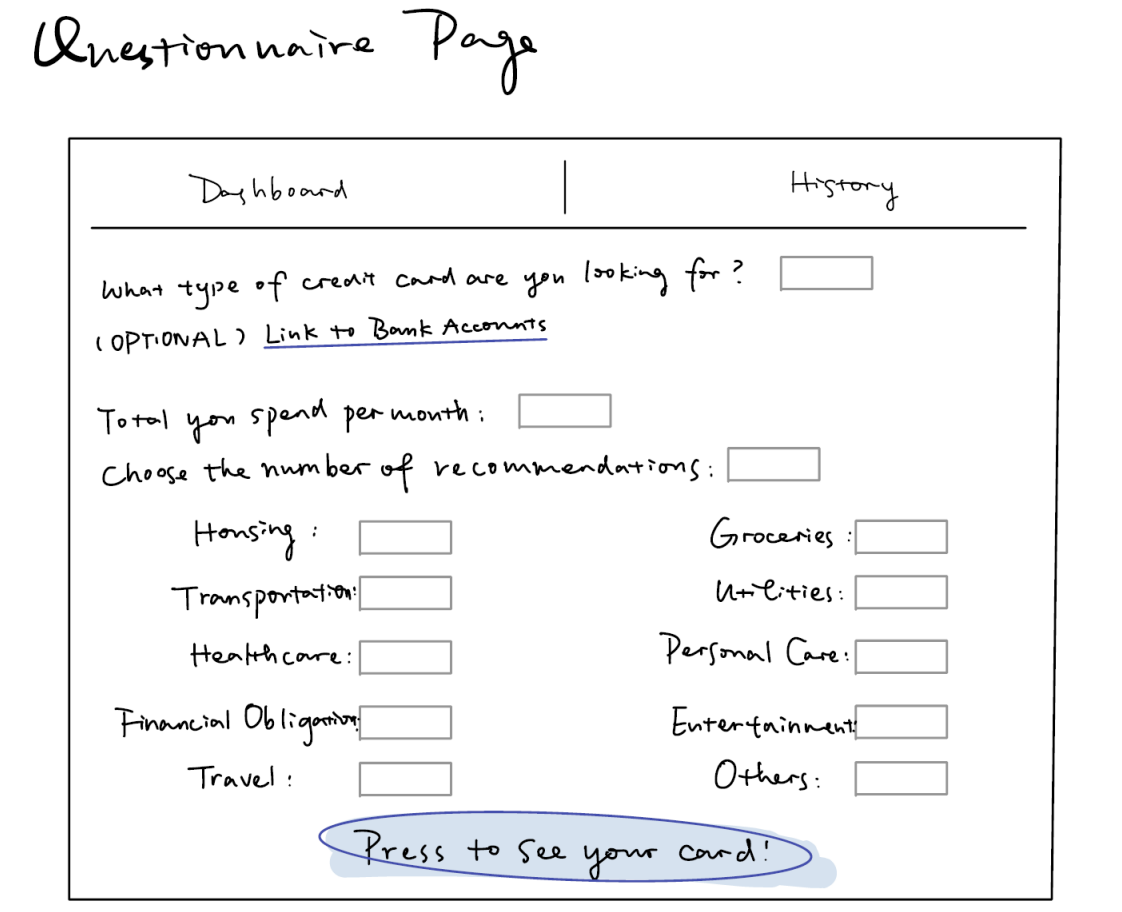
- Dev time (team); Hosting on Duke VCM;
- API usage (free-tier / low cost);
- Maintenance of card dataset (manual curation).

Revenue Streams

- Subscription (premium: multi-card optimization, partner valuation tuning);
- Affiliate referrals (NOT implemented in class project, out of scope).

Lean Canvas is adapted from The Business Model Canvas (www.businessmodelgeneration.com/canvas). PowerPoint implementation by: Neos Chronos Limited (https://neoschronos.com). License: CC BY-SA 3.0

Questionnaire Page



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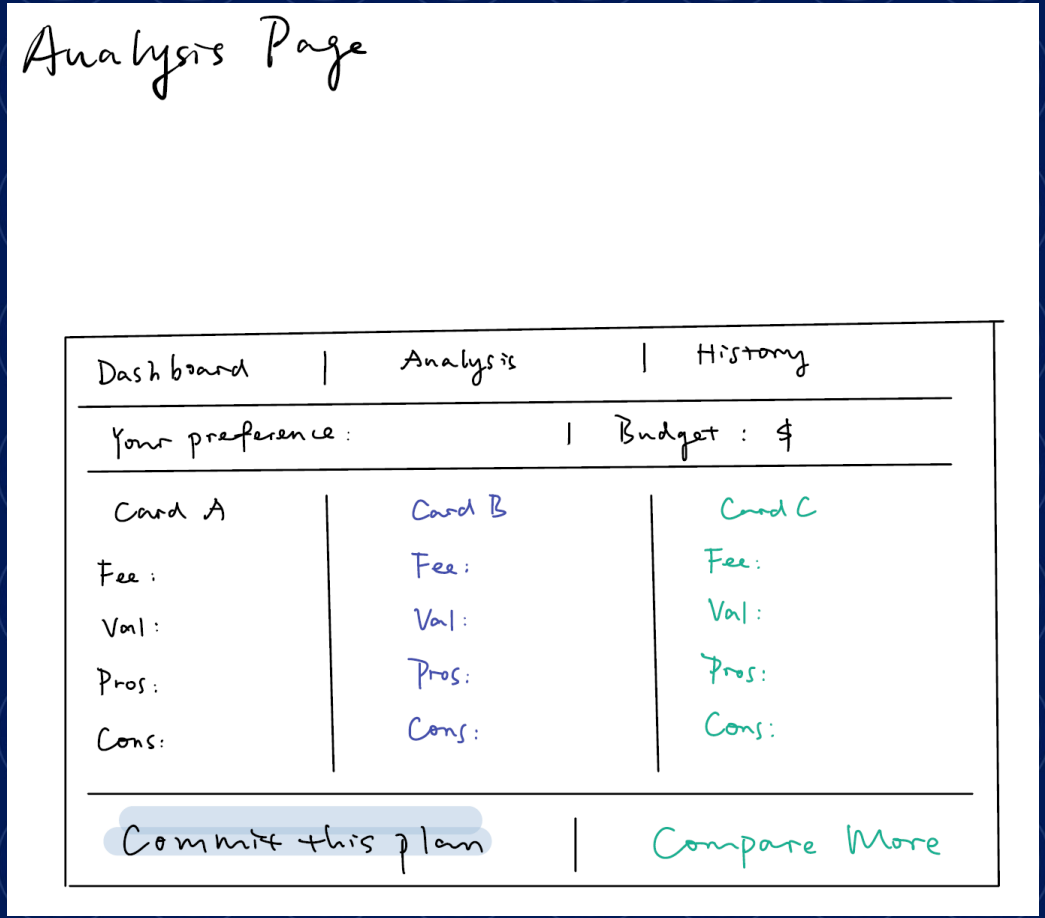
Analysis Page



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